

A dictionary is a set of items; each item consists of a key and a value. You define a dictionary using braces:

```
>>> capitals = {  
...     'AK': 'Juneau',  
...     'AL': 'Montgomery',  
...     'AZ': 'Phoenix',  
... }
```

You access the value associated with a key by stating the dictionary name, followed by the key in brackets:

```
>>> capitals['AK']  
'Juneau'
```

Add items to an existing dictionary by placing the new key in brackets and providing the value:

```
>>> capitals['AR'] = 'Little Rock'
```

Remove items from a dictionary using the `del` keyword:

```
>>> del capitals['AR']
```

This removes both the key and its associated value from the dictionary.